

ENTITY PROFILE — THE DÖMERE

DESIGNATION	The Dömere (a.k.a. "The Buried Judge," "The One Who Remembers Wrongs")
CLASSIFICATION	Tier 2 — Subterranean Presence (Regional Threat)
FORM	Non-corporeal. Manifests as a voice from beneath the earth, speaking in layers of language: Old English, Brythonic, and a pre-Celtic tongue that predates human settlement in Britain. When agitated, causes ground tremors, sinkholes, and localized soil temperature increases. Cannot manifest physically — operates through the Returned, who are fragments of its awareness inhabiting human bodies.
ARTIFACT / TALISMAN	The Society's Field Manual — a handwritten Victorian guide to negotiating with subterranean presences. Found hidden in the Cormsil church crypt. Contains the framework for the 1882 compact and describes methods for binding or silencing entities like the Dömere. The manual itself is not magical — it's a reference document written by people who understood what they were dealing with.
CORRUPTION EMISSION	Aura — +1 Corruption at scene start for anyone in Cormsil while the spirit is active. The Dömere's awareness is ambient — it perceives everything within its geographic radius. Proximity to the standing stone (original resting site) is +2 Corruption per scene.

ORIGIN

The Dömere predates human settlement in Britain. It was already in the earth when the first Celts arrived. The Brigantes tribe encountered it when they dug a ritual well that intersected its resting place. They learned its nature: it responds to wrongful death. It cannot abide an unbalanced ledger. The Celts incorporated it into their justice system — the worst criminals were brought to the well and made to confess. If their crimes were severe enough, the Dömere would claim them.

The Romans tried to destroy it during their conquest of the Brigantes (70s CE) and failed — the Dömere cannot be killed, only contained. The Saxons built a church over the well, then a town around the church. The compact of 1882 was the first successful negotiation — all previous attempts at binding (including Sir Geoffrey Colne's 1642 effort) failed because they treated the spirit as an enemy rather than a party to an agreement.

The Society understood what others didn't: the Dömere is not malicious. It is absolute. It doesn't want to harm. It wants to *correct*. The compact worked because

it gave the spirit what it wanted — acknowledgment. The annual reading was enough. The spirit slept. For 105 years, it was enough.

THE RETURNED — MECHANICAL EFFECT

When someone dies within the Dömere's radius by neglect, violence, or preventable mistake, the spirit may — at its discretion — embody the deceased with a fragment of its awareness. The returned person appears alive and healthy. They retain the deceased's memories, personality, and relationships — with subtle distortions.

Tells: Slowed blink rate (3-4 seconds between blinks), consistently cool skin temperature (~34°C), tendency to complete others' sentences or speak in unison with other returned, and the compulsion to visit the person responsible for their death.

Escalation Pattern: Daily visits → statements of "forgiveness" → constant presence → the responsible person cannot sleep, eat, or function → psychological collapse. The returned are not consciously malevolent. They believe they are genuinely forgiving the person. They don't understand what they're doing. The spirit acts through them without their knowledge.

Vulnerability: A returned person who becomes fully self-aware — who understands what they are and what they're being used to do — can resist the compulsion. They can choose to act independently of the spirit's will. This is the basis for the volunteer component of the silencing ritual.

CONTAINMENT PROFILE

Quiescence Condition: The Dömere can be forced into dormancy through a ritual requiring three components: (1) its true name — "Dömere" — spoken aloud at the original resting site; (2) soil from the pre-Saxon site (the standing stone in Dwerryhouse's field); and (3) a returned volunteer who chooses to release the spirit's fragment, speaking words of release from the Society's manual.

Alternative — New Compact: The Dömere can be negotiated with. The Society's manual provides the framework. The spirit responds to acknowledgment and formal agreement. A new compact would require terms acceptable to the spirit — likely harsher than 1882, given that the previous compact was destroyed and the spirit was forgotten for 105 years.

Inadvertent Activation Risk: The Dömere is awake. It cannot be made "more" awake. However, actions that the spirit perceives as interference — attempting exorcism, threatening the returned, damaging the standing stone — will escalate its response from passive (the returned visiting Eleanor) to active (ground tremors, direct speech, expansion attempts).

Containment Procedure: Either perform the silencing ritual at the standing stone with all three components, or negotiate a new compact. Monitor the site annually. The standing stone must remain undisturbed. The well beneath must remain capped. Record and acknowledge any wrongful deaths within the Dömere's radius — the spirit's function is acknowledgment, and regular acknowledgment may prevent reawakening.

CONTAINMENT TRUTHS

Three facts must be discovered before the entity can be safely contained:

CT-1 — Trigger Condition: The Dömere wakes when a binding compact is broken or when an extended period passes without acknowledgment of wrongful deaths within its radius. The library fire destroyed the compact; the spirit woke immediately. It will wake again if any future compact is violated. *Sources: Colne's manuscript (L6), the Society's manual (L3), the vicar's letter (L5). HQ Fallback: Day 5.*

CT-2 — Appetite: The Dömere is drawn to wrongful death — specifically deaths caused by neglect, violence, or preventable mistakes. It cannot abide an unbalanced moral ledger. It does not distinguish between murder and carelessness — both are wrongs to be corrected. It feeds on the acknowledgment of wrongs; without acknowledgment, it becomes agitated and expansive. *Sources: Colne's manuscript (L6), observation of the returned (L1, L4), the Society's manual (L3). HQ Fallback: Day 4.*

CT-3 — Quiescence Condition: The Dömere can be forced into dormancy through a ritual requiring its true name (spoken at the original resting site), soil from the pre-Saxon site, and a returned volunteer who chooses to release the spirit's

fragment. Alternatively, a new compact can be negotiated — but the spirit's trust has been broken, and its terms will be harsher. *Sources: Colne's manuscript + the Society's manual together (L3, L6), the standing stone (L7). HQ Fallback: Day 2 — synthesis only, not available from a single source.*

Relic Sheet — Case File: The Gormsil Compact. For DA use only. Do not share with players.